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Recruitment Rules relating to various cadres in D/o Posts

DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. Every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations. All chapters have been cross-verified against official Gazette notifications. However, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official Government of India Gazette notifications and Department of Posts circulars for the most reliable and authoritative information.

Edition Notes

This edition of the booklet has been thoroughly revised to reflect the current statutory position as of August 2024. The major corrections incorporated in this edition include:

- MTS RR — substantial restructuring through the Department of Posts (MTS) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2023 notified vide G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023, which abolished Part-I, restructured the method of recruitment, and introduced a new GDS quota with 50% SCF + 50% competitive exam components.
- Postman/Mail Guard RR — Department of Posts Postman and Mail Guard (Group C post) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2023 notified vide G.S.R. 638(E) dated 30.08.2023, which substituted the earlier 25/25/50 split with a new 50% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% (GDS exam / open market DR) structure.
- PA/SA RR — both the First Amendment vide G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023 and the Second Amendment vide G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024 have been incorporated.
- All other chapters have been cross-checked against their respective principal notifications.

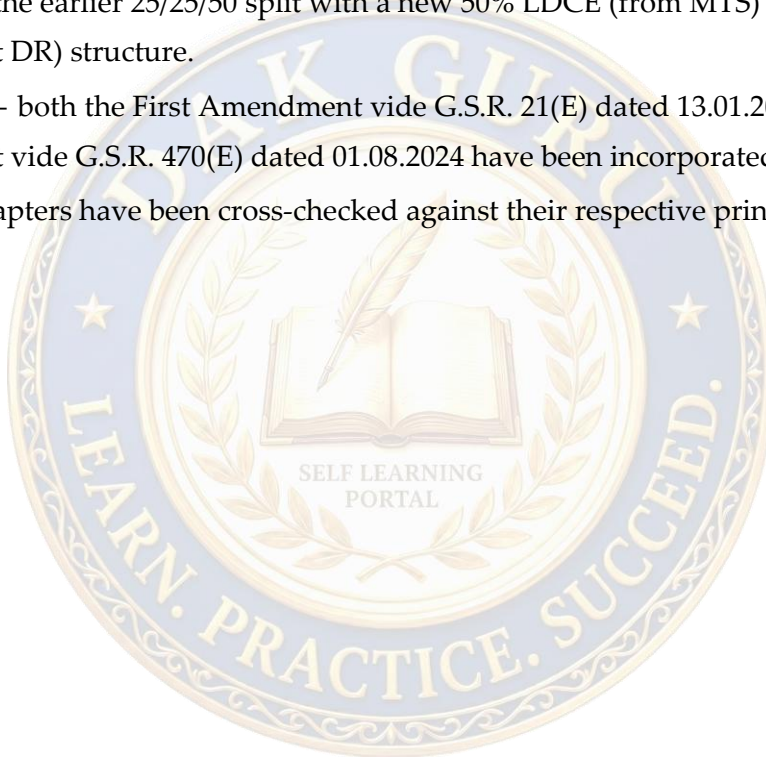


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Chapter 1: Introduction & Constitutional Basis

1.1 What are Recruitment Rules?

Recruitment Rules (RRs) are statutory rules framed under the proviso to Article 309 of the Constitution of India. They regulate the method of recruitment and conditions of service for various posts under the Central Government. In the Department of Posts (DoP), separate RRs are notified through Gazette of India notifications for each cadre.

Every Recruitment Rule notification follows a standard 13-point Schedule format prescribed by the Department of Personnel & Training (DoPT), covering essential parameters from the name of the post to the composition of the Departmental Promotion Committee (DPC).

1.2 Constitutional Foundation

Article 309 (Proviso): Acts of the appropriate Legislature may regulate the recruitment, and conditions of service of persons appointed, to public services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union or of any State. Provided that it shall be competent for the President or such person as he may direct, in the case of services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union, to make rules regulating the recruitment and the conditions of service of persons appointed, to such services and posts until provision in that behalf is made by or under an Act of the appropriate Legislature.

★ **NOTE:** Article 309 proviso is the enabling provision for ALL recruitment rules. The President makes RRs, published via Gazette Notification (G.S.R. number).

1.3 The Standard 13-Point Schedule Format

Every RR notification in DoP follows this uniform schedule prescribed by DoPT:

Col. No.	Parameter
1	Name of the Post
2	Number of Posts (with * subject to variation on workload)
3	Classification (GCS, Group, Gazetted/Non-Gazetted, Ministerial/Non-Ministerial)
4	Pay Level in the Pay Matrix (7th CPC)

Col. No.	Parameter
5	Whether Selection Post or Non-Selection Post
6	Age Limit for Direct Recruits
7	Educational & Other Qualifications for Direct Recruits
8	Whether age & educational qualifications for DR apply to Promotees
9	Period of Probation, if any
10	Method of Recruitment (DR / Promotion / Deputation / LDCE) with Percentages
11	In case of Promotion/Deputation – Feeder Grade & Qualifying Service
12	Composition of DPC
13	Circumstances in which UPSC to be consulted

1.4 Key Amendments Tracker

Multiple RRs in DoP have been amended over the years. The most significant wave of amendments came in 2017, when the 7th CPC pay matrix levels were substituted in all existing RRs through a series of G.S.R. notifications (649(E) to 655(E), all dated 28.06.2017).

More recently, the year 2023 saw major structural changes through two key notifications dated 30.08.2023:

- **G.S.R. 639(E):** Department of Posts (Multi Tasking Staff) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2023 — abolished Part-I structure; introduced 50% SCF + 50% competitive exam quota for GDS in MTS recruitment.
- **G.S.R. 638(E):** Department of Posts Postman and Mail Guard (Group C post) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2023 — substituted the earlier 25%+25%+50% split with a new 50% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% (GDS exam, then open-market DR) structure.

The PA/SA RR 2022 (G.S.R. 459(E) dated 17.06.2022) has been amended twice:

- **First Amendment:** G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023 — title change ("&" replaced with "and"); proviso added for GDS-clubbed qualifying service of 5 years; induction training within 2 years; revised juniors/seniors clause.
- **Second Amendment:** G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024 — substituted Note 3 in column (11) Part (B) for all five PA/SA sub-cadres, refining the juniors/seniors eligibility for LDCE/competitive examination.

Chapter 2: Common Provisions Across All Recruitment Rules

All RR notifications in the Department of Posts contain certain standard rules that are common across cadres. Understanding these ensures you do not waste time re-reading repetitive language in each notification.

2.1 Disqualification (Bigamy Clause)

Every RR contains a standard disqualification clause: No person who has entered into or contracted a marriage with a person having a spouse living, or who, having a spouse living, has entered into or contracted a marriage with any person, shall be eligible for appointment. However, the Central Government may exempt a person if such marriage is permissible under the personal law applicable to them.

★ **NOTE:** *This is a verbatim common clause across ALL cadre RRs. If asked 'Which clause is common to all RRs?' — Disqualification (Bigamy) is the answer.*

2.2 Power to Relax

Where the Central Government is of the opinion that it is necessary or expedient so to do, it may, by order, for reasons to be recorded in writing, and in consultation with the UPSC (where applicable), relax any of the provisions of the rules with respect to any class or category of persons.

2.3 Saving Clause (Reservation)

Nothing in the rules shall affect reservations, relaxation of age-limit and other concessions required to be provided for the Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Ex-Servicemen, Other Backward Classes and other special categories of persons in accordance with the orders issued by the Central Government from time to time.

2.4 Liability for Service

Many cadre RRs (PA/SA, Postman, MTS) specifically include a clause that: Any person appointed to the post shall be liable to serve anywhere in India including in Army Postal Services. This is particularly notable for PA/SA and Postman cadres.

2.5 Standard Note on Juniors-Seniors (DPC / LDCE Consideration)

Almost all RRs with promotion provisions carry a standard note on consideration of seniors when juniors are eligible. The exact wording was substantially refined by amendments in 2023 and 2024. The current consolidated position (as substituted by the various 2023/2024 amendments) is:

Where juniors who have completed their qualifying or eligibility service are being considered for promotion (or are eligible for LDCE/Competitive Examination), their seniors shall also be considered, provided —

- (a) both the senior and junior were recruited through the same mode of recruitment and were holding the same feeder cadre prior to appointment to the present post on a regular basis; or
- (b) seniors are not short of the requisite qualifying or eligibility service by more than half of such qualifying or eligibility service or two years, whichever is less, and have successfully completed their probation period for promotion to the next higher grade along with their juniors who have already completed such qualifying or eligibility service.

The condition shall not apply with reference to a junior official who has lost seniority after availing transfer under Rule 38 of the Postal Manual Volume IV (introduced through 2023/2024 amendments).

Chapter 3: Multi Tasking Staff (MTS) – Group C

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 781(E) dated 16.08.2018

Short Title: Department of Posts (Multi Tasking Staff) Recruitment Rules, 2018

Superseded: MTS Recruitment Rules, 2010 (and subsequent amendments)

Amendment History

1. First Amendment: G.S.R. 850(E) dated 15.11.2019 — Department of Posts (Multi Tasking Staff) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2019.
2. Second Amendment: G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023 — Department of Posts (Multi Tasking Staff) Recruitment (Amendment) Rules, 2023. THIS IS A MAJOR STRUCTURAL OVERHAUL, NOT A PAY-MATRIX UPDATE.

AMENDED: The 2023 amendment is the most consequential change to the MTS RR. It abolished the earlier Part-I (Administrative Offices) entirely, removed the heading of Part-II, restructured column (10) Method of Recruitment, revised the DPC composition under column (12), and introduced a new provision allowing inter-circle GDS appointment to Delhi Postal Circle.

Key Changes Brought by G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023

1. PART-I (relating to Administrative Offices) and all entries relating thereto have been omitted entirely.
2. In PART-II, the heading "PART II – Posts of Subordinate Office" has been omitted; the RR now applies as a single unified schedule.
3. Under column (7), item number (ii) and the entries relating thereto have been omitted.
4. Under column (10), items (i), (ii) and (iii) have been completely substituted with a new three-tier recruitment structure.
5. Under column (12), the DPC composition has been replaced with a fresh composition for the Group 'C' Departmental Confirmation Committee.
6. A new Note 3 inserted permitting inter-circle GDS appointment to Delhi Postal Circle through administrative instructions.

Basic Parameters (Current Position post-2023 Amendment)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 1 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 18,000 – 56,900)
Selection / Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Probation	Two years for Direct Recruits + successful completion of mandatory training prescribed by the Department of Posts
APS Liability	Liable to serve in Army Postal Service in India or abroad

Method of Recruitment (as substituted by G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023)

The current method of recruitment is a three-tier cascade. Each tier is exhausted before the next is invoked:

Tier (i) – Casual Labourer Cascade (Six-Step Priority Order)

Step	Source	Basis
(a)	100% by appointment of casual labourers of the recruiting Division or Unit, conferred with temporary status	Seniority-cum-Fitness
(b)	Casual labourers of the recruiting Division or Unit, engaged on or before 1st September, 1993, working for eight hours in a day	Seniority-cum-Fitness
(c)	Part-time casual labourers of the recruiting Division or Unit, engaged on or before 1st September, 1993	Seniority-cum-Fitness
(d)	Casual labourers of all the other Divisions or Units of the Circle, conferred with temporary status	Seniority-cum-Fitness
(e)	Casual labourers of all the other Divisions or Units of the Circle, engaged on or before 1st September, 1993, working for eight hours in a day	Seniority-cum-Fitness
(f)	Part-time casual labourers of all the other Divisions or Units of the Circle, engaged on or before 1st September, 1993	Seniority-cum-Fitness

If still unfilled, vacancies move to Tier (ii) below.

Tier (ii) – GDS Quota (NEW – Introduced by 2023 Amendment)

- **(a) 50% by Seniority-cum-Fitness** from amongst willing Gramin Dak Sevak of the recruiting Division or Unit, who have worked regularly for **five years** in that capacity, as on the 1st day of January of the year to which the vacancy belongs, or as per Central Government guidelines issued from time to time. Unfilled vacancies are added to Tier (ii)(b).
- **(b) 50% by Competitive Examination** restricted to Gramin Dak Sevak of the recruiting Postal Circle, who have worked regularly for **three years** in that capacity, as on the 1st day of January of the year to which the vacancy belongs, or as per Central Government guidelines. Unfilled vacancies go to Tier (iii).

Tier (iii) — Direct Recruitment from Open Market

By direct recruitment from the open market as per the scheme circulated by the Department of Posts from time to time.

★ **NOTE:** The 5-year (SCF) and 3-year (competitive exam) GDS service thresholds are top-priority exam facts. Earlier study material stating that MTS recruitment is "Casual Labourers, then 100% Direct Recruitment" is based on the unamended 2018 RR and is no longer correct.

DPC Composition (as substituted by G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023)

Group 'C' Departmental Confirmation Committee (for considering confirmation):

1. Chairman — Assistant Postmaster General OR Senior Superintendent of Post Offices OR Senior Superintendent of Railway Mail Service OR Assistant Director OR Superintendent of Post Offices OR Superintendent of Railway Mail Service.
2. Members — Two Group 'B' (Gazetted) Officers.

Special Provision — Delhi Postal Circle (NEW Note 3 inserted by 2023 Amendment)

The Department of Posts may, through administrative instructions, allow Gramin Dak Sevak of one or more Postal Circles, who are otherwise eligible as per the provisions of these rules, for appointment in Delhi Postal Circle. Such appointment shall be subject to such terms and conditions as may be decided by the Department of Posts from time to time.

Key Points for Exam

- MTS is the lowest rung in the regular cadre hierarchy of the Department of Posts.

- The 2023 amendment introduced a GDS-specific quota for the first time — 50% SCF (5 years service) + 50% competitive examination (3 years service).
- The earlier multi-Part structure (Part-I to Part-V) has been abolished by the 2023 amendment; the RR now applies uniformly.
- The casual labourer cascade prioritizes the recruiting Division/Unit first, then extends to all other Divisions/Units of the same Circle.
- The competitive examination under Tier (ii)(b) is restricted to GDS of the recruiting Postal Circle — it is not all-India or open.
- Delhi Postal Circle has a unique provision allowing GDS from other Circles to apply via administrative instructions.
- MTS remains a Non-Ministerial post (no direct handling of files/correspondence).

⚠ IMPORTANT: Cascade logic to memorise — Casual Labourers (6 sub-steps a to f) → GDS Quota (50% SCF with 5 years + 50% competitive exam with 3 years) → Open Market Direct Recruitment. Any MCQ asking the order of priority must reflect this three-tier structure.



Chapter 4: Postman & Mail Guard – Group C

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 899(E) dated 20.09.2018

Short Title: Department of Posts Postman and Mail Guard (Group C post) Recruitment Rules, 2018

Superseded: Postman and Mail Guard Recruitment Rules, 2010

Amendment History

1. First Amendment: G.S.R. 157(E) dated 05.03.2020 — substituted column (7) educational qualifications; introduced 2-year window for driving licence acquisition for those without one at appointment.
2. Second Amendment: G.S.R. 638(E) dated 30.08.2023 — MAJOR STRUCTURAL OVERHAUL, completely revising columns (7), (9), (10) and (11) for both Postman and Mail Guard posts.

AMENDED: The 2023 amendment fundamentally restructured Postman/MG recruitment. The earlier ratio of 25% promotion (SCF) + 25% promotion (LDCE) + 50% direct recruitment has been completely abolished. The new structure is 50% by LDCE from MTS + 50% by competitive examination limited to GDS, failing which by direct recruitment from open market.

Basic Parameters (Current Position post-2023 Amendment)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 3 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 21,700 – 69,100)
Selection / Non-Selection	Non-Selection
Probation (DR)	Two years and successful completion of mandatory training prescribed by DoP, and passing of local language test (where applicable)
APS Liability	Liable to serve in Army Postal Service

Educational Qualifications under Column (7) — as substituted by G.S.R. 638(E) dated 30.08.2023**For Postman:**

1. 10th standard pass from a recognized Board for persons who are working as Gramin Dak Sevak in the Department of Posts, and 12th standard pass from a recognized Board for all others.
2. Knowledge of working on Computer.
3. Knowledge of local language of the concerned Postal Circle or Division.
4. Possessing a valid licence to drive a two-wheeler or light motor vehicle. Persons with Benchmark Disability shall be exempted from possession of such licence.

For Mail Guard:

1. 10th standard pass from a recognized Board for persons working as GDS, and 12th standard pass from a recognized Board for all others.
2. Knowledge of working on Computer.
3. Knowledge of local language of the concerned Postal Circle or Division.

(Driving licence requirement is unique to Postman; not applicable to Mail Guard.)

✓ **TIP:** Local language test waiver: A person who has passed the local language of the Postal Circle or Division concerned as one of the subjects in 10th standard or above is exempted from the local language test. GDS officials are also exempted. For others not possessing local-language knowledge, appointment is still allowed, but passing the local language test post-appointment is a pre-condition for completion of probation.

⚠ **IMPORTANT:** Driving licence waiver mechanism (Postman): A person without a valid licence to drive a two-wheeler or LMV at the time of appointment shall be appointed but shall not earn periodical increment in pay until the licence is produced OR for a period of five years from the date of appointment, whichever is earlier. Upon production of the licence or expiry of five years, pay shall be restored prospectively to the level it would have reached; no arrears are paid for the intervening period.

Method of Recruitment under Column (10) — as substituted by G.S.R. 638(E) dated 30.08.2023

Applicable identically to both Postman and Mail Guard:

- **(i) 50% by promotion** of Multi Tasking Staff of the recruiting Postal Circle on the basis of Limited Departmental Competitive Examination, failing which the unfilled vacancies shall be added to the number of vacancies to be filled as per (ii) below.
- **(ii) 50% by direct recruitment** on the basis of Competitive Examination limited to Gramin Dak Sevaks of the recruiting Postal Circle, who have worked regularly for **five years** in that capacity, as on 1st January of the year to which the vacancy belongs (or as per Central Government guidelines), failing which by direct recruitment from open market as per the scheme circulated by the Department of Posts from time to time.

⚠ IMPORTANT: The earlier ratio of 25% SCF (from MTS) + 25% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% DR is OBSOLETE. Any study material or MCQ referencing this old ratio is incorrect from 31.08.2023 onwards (date of gazette publication of G.S.R. 638(E)).

Feeder Grade & Qualifying Service under Column (11) — as substituted by 2023 Amendment

Promotion on the basis of Limited Departmental Competitive Examination from:

1. Multi Tasking Staff in Level-1 of the pay matrix with three years regular service in the grade as on 1st January of the vacancy year (or as per Central Government guidelines); AND
2. Multi Tasking Staff in Level-1 of the pay matrix with total regular service of five years including service rendered regularly as Gramin Dak Sevaks as on 1st January of the vacancy year (or as per Central Government guidelines).

★ **NOTE:** The Delhi Postal Circle inter-circle GDS provision (Note 3 in column (10)) applies identically to Postman/MG as to MTS.

Special Provisions on Eligibility (Note 3 under Column 11 — as inserted by 2023 Amendment)

Eligibility of an official shall be determined with respect to the post held substantively and relevant pay level of the post in pay matrix, and NOT with respect to the level in which an official is drawing pay as on the crucial date of eligibility by virtue of financial upgradation under Time Bound One Promotion, Biennial Cadre Review or Modified Assured Career Progression (MACP).

⚠ IMPORTANT: This Note 3 is exam-critical: MACP-upgraded pay level does NOT make an official eligible for promotion in the upgraded grade. Substantive post matters.

DPC Composition

Departmental Promotion Committee (for promotion/confirmation): Composition as prescribed by the Circle Head. Consultation with UPSC is NOT necessary.

Key Points for Exam

- Postman is a Non-Ministerial post (delivery/outdoor work). Mail Guard is also Non-Ministerial.
- The current ratio after the 2023 amendment is 50% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% (GDS exam, failing which open market DR). Memorise this clearly.
- Valid two-wheeler or LMV driving licence is required for Postman ONLY (not Mail Guard). PwBD candidates are exempt.
- GDS candidates have a relaxed educational qualification — 10th standard pass — while all others must have 12th standard pass.
- MTS qualifying service: 3 years in Level-1 (for those without GDS background) OR 5 years combined (including GDS service).
- The Delhi Postal Circle special provision applies to Postman/MG just as it does to MTS.

⚠ IMPORTANT: The cascade structure is simpler now: LDCE first → if unfilled, added to GDS competitive exam quota → if still unfilled, open market DR. The earlier cascade involving SCF + LDCE + DR + cascading across Divisions/RMS is no longer the operative position post-30.08.2023.

Chapter 5: Postal Assistant & Sorting Assistant – Group C

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 459(E) dated 17.06.2022

Short Title: Department of Posts (Postal Assistant and Sorting Assistant) Recruitment Rules, 2022

Superseded: PA & SA (Group C Non-Gazetted) Recruitment Rules, 2015

Amendment History

1. First Amendment: G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023 — title change ("&" replaced by "and"); proviso added clarifying that for officials holding posts in Level 1, Level 2 or Level 3 who rendered regular service as GDS before commencement of the 2022 RR, the total regular service including GDS service shall be 5 years; induction training to be completed within 2 years of appointment; revised juniors/seniors clause.
2. Second Amendment: G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024 — substituted Note 3 of column (11) Part (B) for all five PA/SA sub-cadres, further refining the juniors/seniors eligibility framework and exempting officials who lost seniority under Rule 38 of Postal Manual Volume IV.

5.1 Sub-Cadres Under PA/SA RR 2022

The RR covers FIVE distinct sub-cadres under one notification:

1. PA (Circle Office and Regional Offices)
2. PA (Foreign Post Organisations in Chennai, Delhi, Kolkata, Mumbai)
3. PA (Savings Bank Control and Internal Check Organisations)
4. PA (Post Office)
5. Sorting Assistant (Railway Mail Service)

Basic Parameters

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 4 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 25,500 – 81,100)
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Age Limit (DR)	18 to 27 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3, Govt. Servants as per rules). For GDS: up to 40 years (SC/ST +5, OBC +3).

Parameter	Details
Educational Qualification (DR)	(i) Bachelor's Degree from recognized University/Institute; (ii) Knowledge of working on Computer. Note: 10+2 continues for GDS holding the post on regular basis on the date of notification.
Probation	Two years for Direct Recruits, with successful completion of Induction Training (within 2 years of appointment as per 2023 amendment) at Postal Training Centre.

Method of Recruitment under Column (10)

- **40% by Promotion through LDCE** — from Part (A) feeder grades. Failing which, from Part (B) feeder grades through LDCE. Failing which, by Direct Recruitment.
- **60% by Direct Recruitment** through Competitive Examination.

5.2 Feeder Grades for Promotion through LDCE under Column (11)

Part (A) — Primary Feeder

1. Officials of the Circle holding post in Level 3 of the Pay Matrix with three years of regular service in such post or five years of combined regular service in posts in Level 1, Level 2 and Level 3 of Pay Matrix.
2. Officials of the Circle holding post in Level 2 of the Pay Matrix with five years of regular service in such post including the regular service in posts in Level 1 of Pay Matrix.
3. Officials of the Circle holding post in Level 1 of the Pay Matrix with five years of regular service in such post.

Part (B) — Secondary Feeder

Officials in Level 1 or Level 2 of the Pay Matrix with five years of regular service. (Operative only if Part (A) quota cannot be filled.)

AMENDED: Proviso inserted by G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023: For officials holding post in Level 1, Level 2 or Level 3 of the Pay Matrix who have rendered regular service as Gramin Dak Sevaks on or before the commencement of the PA/SA Recruitment Rules 2022 (i.e., before 17.06.2022), the total regular service INCLUDING the service rendered regularly as GDS shall be five years.

Note 3 under Column (11) Part (B) — as substituted by G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024

Where juniors who have completed qualifying or eligibility service are eligible for Limited Departmental Competitive Examination or Competitive Examination, their seniors would also be considered, on the condition that both the senior and junior were recruited through the same mode of recruitment and were holding the same feeder cadre prior to appointment to the present post on regular basis.

This condition shall not be applied with reference to such junior officials who lost their seniority after availing transfer under Rule 38 of the Postal Manual Volume IV.

★ **NOTE:** PA/SA is the FIRST Ministerial post in the postal hierarchy. It is the gateway cadre for further promotions to LSG → HSG-II → HSG-I → IP (via LDCE) → ASP → PS Gr.B → IPoS. This is the single most important RR for LDCE IP candidates to know thoroughly.

△ **IMPORTANT:** GDS are holders of civil posts but outside regular civil service. Their appointment as PA/SA is treated as Direct Recruitment. The educational qualification for GDS candidates is relaxed to 10+2 (instead of Graduation) for those holding GDS posts on regular basis on the date of notification (17.06.2022).

Key Points for Exam

- Recruitment ratio: 40% LDCE + 60% Direct Recruitment.
- Part (A) feeder is exhausted first; only thereafter Part (B) feeder is considered; only if both fail does the LDCE quota go to DR.
- Induction Training is mandatory and must be completed within 2 years of appointment to the promotional post (substituted by G.S.R. 21(E) dated 13.01.2023).
- Title of the RR was officially changed by the 2023 First Amendment from "& Sorting Assistant" to "and Sorting Assistant".
- The Rule 38 (Postal Manual Vol. IV) transfer exception for juniors/seniors clause was introduced by G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024.

Chapter 6: Stenographer Grade II – Group C

Short Title: Department of Posts (Stenographer Grade II) Recruitment Rules, 2014

Superseded: Stenographer Grade 'D' RR, 1986

Amendment: G.S.R. 654(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC pay matrix substitution)

⚠ IMPORTANT: The exact G.S.R. number and date of the principal 2014 notification could not be fully verified in this booklet. Aspirants are advised to consult the official 2014 gazette publication or the DoP SPN division for authoritative confirmation.

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 4 in the Pay Matrix (formerly PB-1 Rs. 5,200–20,200 + GP 2,400)
Selection / Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Age Limit (DR)	18 to 27 years (Govt. Servants up to 40 years; SC/ST up to 45 years)
Method of Recruitment	By Direct Recruitment through Staff Selection Commission (SSC)
Promotion Pathway	Steno Grade II → Steno Grade I (Level 6) → Eligible for LDCE IP after 8 years

★ **NOTE:** Stenographer Grade-I (Level 6) and Stenographer Grade-II (Level 4) are both eligible feeder grades for LDCE IP examination, with 8 years of qualifying service.

Chapter 7: Lower Selection Grade (LSG) – Group C (Non-Gazetted)

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 62(E) dated 31.01.2011

Short Title: Lower Selection Grade Posts Recruitment Rules, 2011

Amendment: G.S.R. 649(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC Pay Matrix substitution)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group C, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 5 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 29,200 – 92,300)
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Postal Assistants / Sorting Assistants in Level 4
Qualifying Service	Five years of regular service in the feeder grade (Level 4)
Training Requirement	Successful completion of two weeks of Departmental Training
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post

Sub-Categories of LSG Posts

The LSG RR covers nine sub-categories of LSG posts:

1. LSG in Post Offices
2. LSG in RMS Offices
3. LSG in Returned Letter Offices
4. LSG in Foreign Post Office at Mumbai
5. LSG Accountants in Post Offices
6. LSG Accountants in RMS Offices
7. LSG in IPSD (Independent Postal Stores Depot)
8. LSG in Circle Offices and Regional Offices
9. LSG in SB Control Organisation

DPC Composition

1. Director of Postal Services — Chairman
2. Assistant Postmaster General — Member
3. Senior Superintendent of Post Offices — Member

★ **NOTE:** LSG is a pure promotion post with NO direct recruitment or LDCE component. It is the FIRST promotion from PA/SA level. Qualifying service: 5 years in Level 4.



Chapter 8: Higher Selection Grade-II (HSG-II) – Group B (NG)

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 746(E) dated 19.11.2013

Short Title: HSG-II, Group B Posts Recruitment Rules, 2013

Amendment: G.S.R. 650(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC update – Level 6 substituted)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 6 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 35,400 – 1,12,400)
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Lower Selection Grade officials in Level 5 of the Pay Matrix
Qualifying Service	Six years regular service in LSG (Level 5). Transitional: 3 years for those holding LSG on regular basis on the date of notification of RR 2013.
Training Requirement	Successful completion of two weeks Departmental Training related to duties of higher post
Probation	Two years

Sub-Categories

HSG-II posts exist in: (1) Post Offices (including Foreign Post Offices other than at Mumbai), (2) RMS Offices, (3) SB Control Organisation, (4) Circle Office / Regional Offices, (5) Returned Letter Offices, (6) Foreign Posts at Mumbai, (7) Independent Postal Stores Depot.

DPC Composition (same as LSG)

1. Director Postal Services — Chairman
2. Assistant Postmaster General — Member
3. Senior Superintendent of Post Offices — Member

★ **NOTE:** HSG-II (Level 6) is an eligible feeder grade for LDCE IP. Officials in HSG-II with 8 years qualifying service (including service in LSG and PA/SA) are eligible for the LDCE IP exam.

Chapter 9: Higher Selection Grade-I (HSG-I) – Group B (NG)

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 509(E) dated 17.07.2014

Short Title: HSG-I in Post Offices and RMS Offices, Group B Posts Recruitment Rules, 2014

Amendment: G.S.R. 651(E) dated 28.06.2017 (7th CPC update)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 7 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 44,900 – 1,42,400) [formerly PB-2 Rs. 9,300–34,800 + GP 4,600]
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion
Feeder Grade	Higher Selection Grade-II officials in Level 6
Qualifying Service	Five years of regular service in HSG-II (Level 6). Transitional: 3 years for those holding HSG-II on regular basis on the date of notification of RR 2014.
Training Requirement	Successfully completed two weeks Departmental Training
Unfilled vacancies	Posts that cannot be filled due to non-availability of eligible HSG-II officers shall be operated at HSG-II level till eligible officers become available.

DPC Composition

1. Director Postal Services — Chairman
2. Assistant Postmaster General — Member
3. Senior Superintendent of Post Offices — Member

★ **NOTE:** HSG-I (Level 7) is at the same pay level as Inspector Posts. But the promotion pathway is different — HSG-I is part of the clerical line, while IP is a separate cadre filled through LDCE + Direct Recruitment.

⚠ IMPORTANT: If HSG-I vacancies cannot be filled due to non-availability of eligible HSG-II Officials, those posts are operated at HSG-II level until eligible officers become available. This is a unique provision.



Chapter 10: Inspector of Posts (IP) – Group B (Non-Gazetted)

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 89(E) dated 05.02.2019

Short Title: Department of Posts (Inspector Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2019

Superseded: Department of Posts (Inspector Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2013

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Non-Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 7 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 44,900 – 1,42,400)
Number of Posts	2210* (as on 2019; subject to variation dependent on workload)
Selection / Non-Selection	Not Applicable
Age Limit (DR)	Not exceeding 30 years (Relaxable for Govt. Servants up to 5 years)
Educational Qualification (DR)	Bachelor's Degree from a recognized University or Institute
Probation	Two years and mandatory induction training (for both DR and Promotee officers)
Method of Recruitment	33⅓% by Direct Recruitment through SSC + 66⅔% by Promotion through LDCE

10.1 LDCE Eligibility – Feeder Grades (Column 11)

Officials of various grades with EIGHT YEARS of regular qualifying service as on the crucial date are eligible for appearing in LDCE IP:

Sl.	Feeder Grade	Pay Level	Qualifying Service Includes
(a)	Higher Selection Grade-II	Level 6	Including regular service put in as LSG and PA/SA
(b)	Postmaster Grade-II	Level 6	Including regular service put in as Postmaster Gr-I and PA
(c)	Stenographer Grade-I	Level 6	Including regular service put in as Stenographer Gr-II

Sl.	Feeder Grade	Pay Level	Qualifying Service Includes
(d)	Lower Selection Grade	Level 5	Including regular service put in as PA or SA
(e)	Postmaster Grade-I	Level 5	Including regular service put in as PA
(f)	Postal Assistant / Sorting Assistant	Level 4	In all offices
(g)	Stenographer Grade-II	Level 4	In all offices

▲ IMPORTANT: Age limit for LDCE IP: Not exceeding 45 years as on the crucial date of eligibility to which the vacancies pertain. This is distinct from the 30-year age limit applicable only to Direct Recruitment.

DPC / Confirmation Committee

Group B Departmental Confirmation Committee (for considering confirmation):

1. Director of Postal Services — Chairman
2. Assistant Postmaster General — Member
3. Senior Superintendent of Post Offices — Member

UPSC Consultation: Not necessary.

Critical Exam Points

- The DR:LDCE ratio is $33\frac{1}{3} : 66\frac{2}{3}$ (approximately 1:2). This is unique in DoP.
- Eight years qualifying service is the key eligibility parameter for LDCE.
- Service in LOWER grades counts towards the 8 years (e.g., PA/SA time counts for an HSG-II candidate).
- 45 years is the upper age limit for LDCE IP (not 30 years, which is only for DR).
- Induction training completion is mandatory as part of probation for BOTH Direct Recruits and Promotee Officers.

★ NOTE: The LDCE IP feeder grades list is a TOP PRIORITY memorization item. Remember the 7 feeder grades (a) to (g) and their respective qualifying service clubbing rules.

Chapter 11: Assistant Superintendent of Posts (ASP) – Group B (Gazetted)

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 61(E) dated 01.02.2013

Short Title: Department of Posts (Assistant Superintendent of Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2013

Superseded: Department of Posts (Assistant Superintendent of Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2007

7th CPC Amendment: G.S.R. 652(E) dated 28.06.2017 (Pay Band-2 + GP 4600 substituted with Level 8 in the Pay Matrix)

Issuing Authority: Ministry of Communications & IT, Department of Posts; circulated vide F.No. 4-24/2002-SPB-II

Summary of Corrections Applied

Field	Gazette G.S.R. 61(E)
Classification	Group B, Gazetted, MINISTERIAL
Number of Posts	1824* (2012) — subject to variation on workload
Qualifying Service	5 years as IP (3 years transitional)
DPC Chairman	Chief Postmaster General (CPMG) of the Circle
DPC Members	Director of Postal Service + APMG

Basic Parameters

Parameter	Details (per G.S.R. 61(E) dated 01.02.2013)
Name of Post	Assistant Superintendent of Posts (ASP)
Number of Posts	1824* (as on 2012). *Subject to variation dependent on workload.
Classification	General Central Service, Group 'B', Gazetted, Ministerial
Pay (as notified 2013)	Pay Band-2, Rs. 9,300 – 34,800 with Grade Pay of Rs. 4,600
Pay Level (post-7th CPC)	Level 8 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 47,600 – 1,51,100) — via G.S.R. 652(E) dated 28.06.2017
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Age Limit (DR)	Not Applicable (100% promotion post — no direct recruitment)

Parameter	Details (per G.S.R. 61(E) dated 01.02.2013)
Educational Qualification (DR)	Not Applicable
Whether DR qualifications apply to promotees	Not Applicable
Period of Probation	Not Applicable (no provision specified in the RR)

Method of Recruitment

100% by Promotion.

Feeder Grade & Qualifying Service

Promotion of Inspector Posts in the scale of pay of Rs. 9,300 – 34,800 with Grade Pay of Rs. 4,200 in Pay Band-2 (now Level 7 in the Pay Matrix) with five years service in the grade rendered after appointment thereto on a regular basis, who have successfully completed two weeks of Departmental Induction Training.

Notes under Column 11 (verbatim from the Gazette)

- Note 1: The eligibility service for promotion to the post of Assistant Superintendent of Posts shall continue to be three years for persons holding the feeder posts of Inspector Posts on a regular basis on the date of notification of these rules (i.e., as on 01.02.2013).
- Note 2: Where juniors who have completed their qualifying or eligibility service are being considered for promotion, their seniors would also be considered, provided they are not short of the requisite qualifying or eligibility service by more than half of such qualifying or eligibility service or two years, whichever is less, and have successfully completed their probation period for promotion to the next higher grade alongwith their juniors who have already completed such qualifying or eligibility service.
- Note 3: For the purpose of computing minimum qualifying service for promotion, the service rendered on a regular basis by an officer prior to 01.01.2006 (the date from which the revised pay structure based on the Sixth Central Pay Commission recommendations has been extended) shall be deemed to be service rendered in the corresponding pay or pay scale extended based on the recommendations of the Pay Commission.

DPC Composition

Group 'B' Departmental Promotion Committee (for considering promotion):

1. Chief Postmaster General of the Circle — Chairman
2. Director of Postal Service — Member
3. Assistant Postmaster General — Member

UPSC Consultation

Consultation with the Union Public Service Commission is NOT necessary for promotion to ASP.

★ **NOTE:** Although UPSC consultation is not required for ASP promotions (Column 13), the Power to Relax provision (Rule 5) of the ASP RR 2013 specifically requires that any relaxation be made in consultation with the Union Public Service Commission. Distinguish these two: routine promotion = no UPSC; relaxation of rules = UPSC consultation needed.

11.1 Key Points for Exam

- ASP is the FIRST Gazetted post in the postal cadre hierarchy (other than the Accounts Officer cadre). IP is Non-Gazetted; ASP is Gazetted.
- ASP is classified as Ministerial — this is explicitly stated in Column 3 of the gazette and is a commonly omitted detail.
- ASP is filled 100% by Promotion from Inspector of Posts (Level 7). There is no Direct Recruitment, no LDCE, and no Deputation.
- Qualifying service: 5 years regular service as IP (with 2 weeks Departmental Induction Training). Transitional: 3 years for those holding IP on regular basis as on 01.02.2013.
- Pay Level: Level 8 in the Pay Matrix (post-7th CPC), feeder IP is Level 7. ASP is therefore one level above IP.
- DPC is chaired by the CPMG of the Circle, with the Director of Postal Service and the Assistant Postmaster General as Members.
- UPSC consultation is not necessary for promotion, but is required for any relaxation of the rules.
- Number of posts: 1824* as on 2012, subject to variation on workload.

✓ **EXAM TRAP:** The single most-tested confusion is the qualifying service figure. ASP requires 5 years as IP (3 years transitional). HSG-II requires 6 years as LSG. Aspirants frequently swap these.

Mnemonic: "ASP = 5 (Five letters? No — Five years); HSG-II = 6." Also remember ASP's 3-year transitional cut-off date is the RR notification date, 01.02.2013.

★ NOTE: *Promotion pathway context — ASP (Level 8) is the immediate promotional grade above IP (Level 7). Regular service rendered as ASP (Level 8) is also counted for reckoning the 8 years qualifying service for promotion to PS Gr.B under the Draft PS Gr.B RR 2024 (not yet notified). See Chapter 12 for the operative-versus-draft position of PS Gr.B.*



Chapter 12: Postal Service Group B (PS Gr.B)

Original Notification: G.S.R. 379 (Postal Superintendent / Postmaster Group B Recruitment Rules, 1987) [G.S.R. number to be verified against the original 1987 Gazette publication]

1993 Amendment: Cadre re-designated from Postal Superintendent / Postmaster Group B to Postal Service Group B

Draft 2024: Draft RR for PS Gr.B circulated vide F.No. 9-14/2010-SPG (Vol.II) dated 11.11.2024 (and further communication dated 13.11.2024) for stakeholder comments

⚠ IMPORTANT: STATUS AS OF AUGUST 2024: The 1987 PS Gr.B RR (as amended in 1993) is the OPERATIVE notification. The Draft 2024 RR is NOT yet notified. The LDCE for PS Gr.B for vacancy years 2021, 2022 and 2023 (held on 30.06.2024) was conducted under the existing 1987 RR pattern (19% IP Line + 6% Clerical Line). Aspirants must check the current status before relying on Draft 2024 provisions for any vacancy year.

✓ **TIP:** Citation caveat — The G.S.R. number 379 (1987) has been propagated from earlier study material and could not be independently verified against the primary 1987 Gazette publication during preparation of this booklet. Aspirants relying on this figure for an exam citation are advised to cross-check the original 1987 Gazette of India (Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3) or the DoP SPG division for authoritative confirmation.

12.1 Operative Position under 1987 RR (as amended in 1993)

Method of Recruitment

- 75% by Promotion (Seniority) from Inspector of Posts (and erstwhile Inspectors of RMS) with 5 years regular service in the grade.
- 19% by Promotion through Departmental Competitive Examination (LDCE) from Inspector of Posts (and erstwhile Inspectors of RMS) with 5 years regular service. [This is commonly referred to as the IP Line quota.]
- 6% by Promotion through the same Departmental Examination from clerical line officials working in Post Offices / Divisional Offices with 5 years regular service in LSG and above. [Commonly referred to as the Clerical Line quota.]

★ **NOTE:** Cadre unification clarification — With the supersession of the Inspector Posts RR 2013 by the Department of Posts (Inspector Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2019 (G.S.R. 89(E) dated 05.02.2019), Inspector of Posts and Inspector of RMS are now a unified cadre. References to "Inspectors of RMS" in the 1987 PS Gr.B RR are accordingly read as part of the consolidated Inspector of Posts cadre at

Level 7. For all current operational purposes (including the LDCE PS Gr.B 2024 conducted on 30.06.2024), the feeder grade for the 75% + 19% quotas is simply Inspector of Posts in Level 7.

Quota-wise LDCE Composition

Quota	Source	Eligibility	Mode
75%	IP Line (Inspector of Posts cadre)	5 years regular service in IP grade	Promotion (Seniority-cum-Fitness)
19%	IP Line (Inspector of Posts cadre)	5 years regular service in IP grade	LDCE (Departmental Competitive Examination)
6%	Clerical Line (officials in Post Offices / Divisional Offices)	5 years regular service in LSG and above	LDCE (same Departmental Competitive Examination as the 19% quota)

12.2 Draft RR 2024 – Key Proposed Changes

Parameter	Proposed in Draft RR 2024
Classification	General Central Service, Non-Ministerial, Gazetted, Group B
Pay Level	Level 9 in the Pay Matrix
Number of Posts	1,091* (2024) *Subject to variation
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	100% by Promotion (proposed)
Feeder Grade	Inspector of Posts in Level 7 with 8 years regular service in the grade + successful completion of minimum two weeks Departmental Induction Training
Service Count	Regular service rendered as ASP (Level 8) shall also be taken into account for reckoning the 8 years qualifying service

Parameter	Proposed in Draft RR 2024
DPC Composition	(1) CPMG or equivalent — Chairman; (2) Director of Postal Services or equivalent — Member; (3) Sr. Superintendent PO (STS level) or equivalent — Member
UPSC Consultation	Not necessary

Stakeholder Suggestions on Draft RR 2024 (for context)

- Interchangeable postings — Allow HSG-I and ASP officials to switch roles for departmental growth.
- Proportional representation — Some associations have requested increasing the General Line Cadre reservation in PS Group B to 30%.
- Revive Postmaster Cadre pathways — Restore promotional opportunities for officials from the abolished Postmaster Cadre.

12.3 Comparison: 1987 RR (Operative) vs Draft RR 2024 (Proposed)

Aspect	1987 RR (Operative)	Draft RR 2024 (Proposed)
Method of Recruitment	75% Promotion + 19% LDCE (IP Line) + 6% LDCE (Clerical Line)	100% Promotion from IP cadre (no LDCE)
Feeder Grade	Inspector of Posts (5 yrs) AND Clerical Line officials (LSG+ with 5 yrs)	Inspector of Posts ONLY (8 yrs in Level 7)
Clerical Line Pathway	Available via 6% LDCE quota	PROPOSED TO BE REMOVED
LDCE Component	Available (25% combined: 19% + 6%)	PROPOSED TO BE REMOVED
ASP Service Counting	ASP service not separately reckoned for IP eligibility	Regular ASP service (Level 8) counts towards the 8-year IP qualifying service
Pay Level	Level 9 (post-7th CPC)	Level 9 (unchanged)
DPC Composition	As per 1987/1993 provisions	CPMG (Chair) + DPS + Sr.SPO STS-level

Aspect	1987 RR (Operative)	Draft RR 2024 (Proposed)
UPSC Consultation	Not necessary	Not necessary



Chapter 13: Accounts Officer & Assistant Accounts Officer – Group B

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 320(E) dated 02.04.2018

Short Title: Indian Posts and Telecommunications Accounts and Finance Service Group B (Accounts Officers and AAO) Recruitment Rules, 2018

13.1 Accounts Officer (AO)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Civil Service, Group B, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 9 (Rs. 53,100 – 1,67,800)
Selection / Non-Selection	Selection Post
Method of Recruitment	By Promotion, failing which by Deputation
Feeder Grade	AAO in Level 8 (Rs. 47,600 – 1,51,100) with 2 years regular service
Training	Mandatory training in field of duties, to be completed within 1 year of DPC meeting
DPC	(1) Advisor (Finance), Telecom Commission – Chairman; (2) DDG (Estb. & Finance), DoT – Member; (3) DDG (Postal Accounts & Finance) – Member

13.2 Assistant Accounts Officer (AAO)

Parameter	Details
Classification	General Central Service, Group B, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial
Pay Level	Level 8 (Rs. 47,600 – 1,51,100)
Age Limit (DR)	Not exceeding 30 years (relaxable for Government servants by 5 years)
Educational Qualification (DR)	Essential: Bachelor's Degree. Desirable: CA / Cost & Management Accountant / CS / M.Com / MBA (Finance)

Parameter	Details
Probation	Two years for both DR and Promotees (Group B promotees exempt). DR must qualify SAS exam or equivalent during probation.
Method of Recruitment	By Promotion, failing which by Deputation, failing which by Direct Recruitment
UPSC Consultation	Not necessary

Feeder Grades for Promotion (subject to SAS/equivalent exam)

Departmental candidates who have passed SAS exam or equivalent:

1. Senior/Junior Accountants in Level 6 / Level 5 with 3 years / 6 years service respectively.
2. All Group C employees with degree — qualifying service varies by pay level:
 - Level 1: 14 years
 - Level 2: 13 years
 - Level 3: 11 years
 - Level 4: 9 years
 - Level 5: 7 years
 - Level 6: 4 years

★ **NOTE:** The AAO cadre has a unique multi-level qualifying service structure. The specific values to memorise are: Level 1 = 14 yrs, Level 2 = 13 yrs, Level 3 = 11 yrs, Level 4 = 9 yrs, Level 5 = 7 yrs, Level 6 = 4 yrs.

Chapter 14: Indian Postal Service (IPoS) – Group A

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 1010(E) dated 10.08.2017

Short Title: Indian Postal Service (Group A Posts) Recruitment Rules, 2017

Superseded: Indian Postal Service Group A Posts Recruitment Rules, 2016

14.1 Grades and Pay Structure (Schedule I)

Sl.	Grade	Level	Pay Range (Rs.)	Authorized Strength
1	Apex Scale	Level 17	2,25,000 (Fixed)	1
2	Higher Administrative Grade+	Level 16	2,05,400 – 2,24,400	7
3	Higher Administrative Grade	Level 15	1,82,200 – 2,24,100	27
4	Senior Administrative Grade	Level 14	1,44,200 – 2,18,200	78
5	Junior Administrative Grade (NFSG)	Level 13	1,18,500 – 2,14,100	30% of senior duty posts
6	Junior Administrative Grade	Level 12	78,800 – 2,09,200	109
7	Senior Time Scale	Level 11	67,700 – 2,08,700	102
8	Junior Time Scale	Level 10	56,100 – 1,77,500	151
9	Reserve	—	—	86
	TOTAL			561

14.2 Method of Recruitment to Junior Time Scale (Entry Level)

- 50% by Direct Recruitment through Civil Services Examination conducted by UPSC.
- 50% by Promotion from: PS Group B in Level 9 AND Senior Postmaster Grade in Level 8, with 2 years regular service + completion of 2 weeks Departmental Induction Training.

14.3 Promotion Criteria for Higher Grades (Schedule II)

From Grade	To Grade	Min. Service Required	Selection Type
JTS (Level 10)	STS (Level 11)	4 years in JTS + 2 weeks training	Selection

From Grade	To Grade	Min. Service Required	Selection Type
STS (Level 11)	JAG (Level 12)	5 years in STS + 2 weeks training	Selection
JAG (Level 12)	JAG-NFSG (Level 13)	Entered 14th year of service	Seniority subject to suitability
JAG (Level 12)	SAG (Level 14)	8 years in JAG/NFSG OR 17 years in Group A + 2 weeks training	Selection
SAG (Level 14)	HAG (Level 15)	3 years in SAG OR 25 years in Group A + 2 weeks training	Selection
HAG (Level 15)	HAG+ (Level 16)	1 year in HAG	Selection
HAG+ (Level 16)	Apex (Level 17)	1 year in HAG+	Selection

Key Features of IPoS RR 2017

- Probation: 2 years for both DR and Promotees.
- Non-Functional Upgradation (NFU): Linked to IAS officer postings at the Centre (Schedule IV).
- Seniority: Determined by Government instructions from time to time.
- Liability: Officers are liable to serve anywhere including in Army Postal Service.
- Controlling Authority: Ministry of Communications, Department of Posts.

★ **NOTE:** The IPoS RR 2017 has FOUR Schedules: Schedule I (Grades & Strength), Schedule II (Method of Recruitment & Qualifying Service), Schedule III (DPC/DCC Composition), Schedule IV (Non-Functional Upgradation). Remember this 4-Schedule structure.

Chapter 15: Staff Car Driver Cadre – Group C

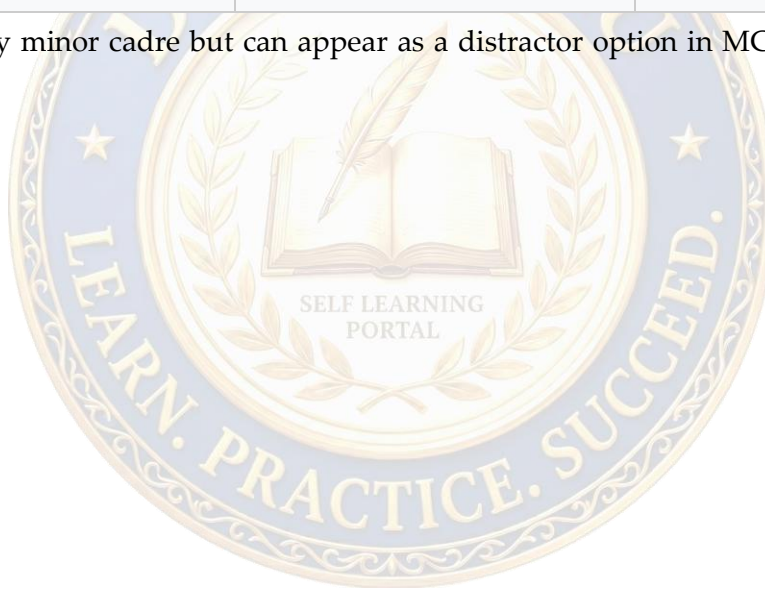
Principal Notification: G.S.R. of 2015 – Staff Car Driver (Grade-I, Grade-II, Ordinary Grade)

Short Title: Department of Posts Staff Car Driver (Grade-I, Grade-II and Ordinary Grade) Recruitment Rules, 2015

Amendment: G.S.R. 88(E) – Amendment Rules (7th CPC pay matrix update)

Grade	Pay Level	Method
Staff Car Driver (Ordinary Grade)	Level 2 (formerly PB-1 + GP 1,900)	100% by DR or Promotion from Group D
Staff Car Driver (Grade-II)	Level 4 (formerly PB-1 + GP 2,400)	By Promotion from Ordinary Grade
Staff Car Driver (Grade-I)	Level 5 (formerly PB-1 + GP 2,800)	By Promotion from Grade-II

This is a relatively minor cadre but can appear as a distractor option in MCQs about Group C posts.



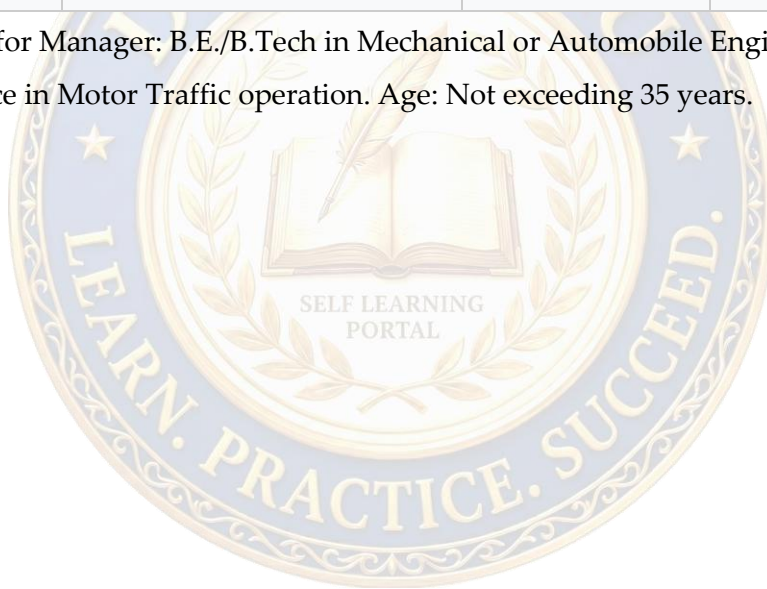
Chapter 16: Mail Motor Service Cadre

Principal Notification: G.S.R. 105(E) dated 18.02.2015

Short Title: Department of Posts, Mail Motor Service, Senior Manager (NFSG), Senior Manager and Manager Recruitment Rules, 2015

Post	Classification	Pay Level	Method
Manager, MMS	GCS Group A, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial	Level 10 (formerly PB-3 + GP 5,400)	By DR or Deputation
Senior Manager, MMS	GCS Group A, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial	Level 11	By Promotion from Manager
Senior Manager (NFSG), MMS	GCS Group A, Gazetted, Non-Ministerial	Level 12	By Promotion from Senior Manager

DR Qualification for Manager: B.E./B.Tech in Mechanical or Automobile Engineering, with three years of experience in Motor Traffic operation. Age: Not exceeding 35 years.

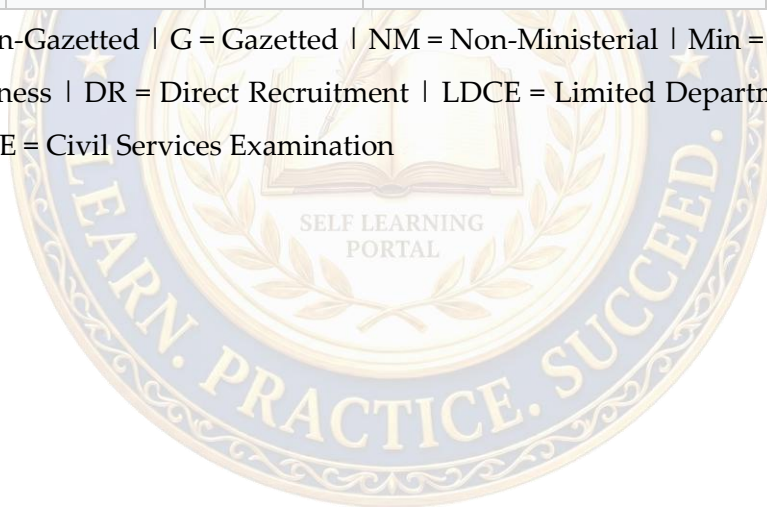


Chapter 17: Master Comparative Table – All Cadres at a Glance

Cadre	Group	Level	Method of Recruitment	Key Qualifying Service
MTS	C (NG, NM)	Level 1	Casual Labourers (6-step cascade) → GDS Quota (50% SCF + 50% Exam) → Open Market DR	GDS SCF: 5 yrs GDS Exam: 3 yrs
Postman / MG	C (NG, NM)	Level 3	50% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% (GDS Exam, then Open DR)	MTS: 3 yrs (or 5 yrs combined with GDS) GDS: 5 yrs
PA / SA	C (NG, Min)	Level 4	40% LDCE + 60% DR	Level 3: 3 yrs / Level 1-2 (combined incl. GDS): 5 yrs
Steno Gr-II	C (NG, Min)	Level 4	100% DR (SSC)	N/A
LSG	C (NG, Min)	Level 5	100% Promotion	PA/SA: 5 yrs in Level 4
HSG-II	B (NG, Min)	Level 6	100% Promotion	LSG: 6 yrs in Level 5
Steno Gr-I	B (NG, Min)	Level 6	100% Promotion	Steno Gr-II: prescribed service
HSG-I	B (NG, Min)	Level 7	100% Promotion	HSG-II: 5 yrs in Level 6
Inspector Posts	B (NG, Min)	Level 7	33⅓% DR + 66⅔% LDCE	8 yrs regular service (all feeders)
ASP	B (G)	Level 8	100% Promotion	IP: 6 yrs in Level 7

Cadre	Group	Level	Method of Recruitment	Key Qualifying Service
AAO	B (G, NM)	Level 8	Promotion / Deputation / DR	SAS exam + prescribed service
PS Gr.B (1987)	B (G, NM)	Level 9	75% Prom. + 19% Exam (IP) + 6% Exam (Clerical)	5 yrs in IP/Insp.RMS/LSG
PS Gr.B (Draft 2024)	B (G, NM)	Level 9	100% Promotion (proposed, not yet notified)	IP: 8 yrs in Level 7 (ASP service counts)
AO	B (G, NM)	Level 9	Promotion / Deputation	AAO: 2 yrs in Level 8
IPoS (JTS)	A (G)	Level 10	50% DR (CSE) + 50% Promotion	PS Gr.B (L-9) / Sr.PM (L-8): 2 yrs

Legend: NG = Non-Gazetted | G = Gazetted | NM = Non-Ministerial | Min = Ministerial | SCF = Seniority-cum-Fitness | DR = Direct Recruitment | LDCE = Limited Departmental Competitive Examination | CSE = Civil Services Examination



Chapter 18: Exam-Oriented Quick Revision Notes

18.1 Frequently Tested Facts

Topic	Key Point
Article 309 proviso	Constitutional basis for all Recruitment Rules
13-Point Schedule	Standard format prescribed by DoPT for all RRs
Disqualification (Bigamy)	Common clause in ALL cadre RRs
Power to Relax	In consultation with UPSC (where applicable), for reasons recorded in writing
Saving Clause	Reservation for SC/ST/OBC/Ex-Servicemen not affected
MTS RR 2018 (current)	G.S.R. 781(E) + Amendments G.S.R. 850(E)/2019 + G.S.R. 639(E)/2023. Cascade: Casual Labourers (6 steps) → GDS Quota (50% SCF/5 yrs + 50% Exam/3 yrs) → Open DR
Postman/MG RR 2018 (current)	G.S.R. 899(E) + Amendments G.S.R. 157(E)/2020 + G.S.R. 638(E)/2023. Ratio: 50% LDCE (from MTS) + 50% (GDS Exam, then Open DR)
PA/SA RR 2022 (current)	G.S.R. 459(E) + Amendments G.S.R. 21(E)/2023 + G.S.R. 470(E)/2024. Ratio: 40% LDCE + 60% DR. Graduation (GDS: 10+2)
IP RR 2019	33⅓% DR + 66⅔% LDCE. 8 years qualifying service. 45 years age (LDCE), 30 years (DR)
LSG	100% Promotion. PA/SA with 5 years in Level 4
HSG-II	100% Promotion. LSG with 6 years in Level 5 (3 years transitional)
HSG-I	100% Promotion. HSG-II with 5 years in Level 6 (3 years transitional)
ASP	100% Promotion. IP with 6 years in Level 7
PS Gr.B (1987 RR)	75% Promotion + 19% Exam (IP) + 6% Exam (Clerical). Currently operative.
PS Gr.B (Draft 2024)	100% Promotion from IP. 8 years in Level 7. ASP service counts. NOT YET NOTIFIED.

Topic	Key Point
IPoS JTS	50% DR (CSE by UPSC) + 50% Promotion from PS Gr.B / Sr.PM. 2 years service
AAO qualifying service	Level 1 = 14 yrs, L2 = 13, L3 = 11, L4 = 9, L5 = 7, L6 = 4 years
Probation (common)	2 years for most cadres + mandatory training completion
DPC (Division level)	DPS (Chairman) + APMG (Member) + Sr.SPO (Member) — for IP, ASP, LSG, HSG-I, HSG-II
UPSC consultation	NOT required for most DoP cadre promotions (explicitly stated in Column 13)

18.2 Tricky Comparison Points

Comparison	Key Difference
IP vs HSG-I	Both are Level 7. IP is filled by LDCE + DR; HSG-I is 100% promotion from HSG-II (clerical line).
ASP vs AAO	Both are Level 8 and Gazetted Group B. ASP is Ministerial (Postal Wing); AAO is Non-Ministerial (Accounts Wing).
Postman vs MTS	Postman (Level 3) requires 12th pass (10th for GDS) + driving licence; MTS (Level 1) requires only 10th pass (no qualification for casual labourers).
PA/SA vs Postman	PA/SA is Ministerial (indoor/clerical); Postman is Non-Ministerial (outdoor/delivery).
Selection vs Non-Selection	PA/SA, LSG, HSG-I, HSG-II, AO, PS Gr.B are Selection Posts; Postman is Non-Selection; IP and MTS are 'Not Applicable'.
GDS service requirement (post-2023)	For MTS Tier (ii)(a) SCF: 5 yrs; for MTS Tier (ii)(b) Exam: 3 yrs; for Postman/MG GDS quota: 5 yrs.
DR ratio: IP vs PA/SA	IP: 33⅓% DR; PA/SA: 60% DR. IP has LESS DR and MORE LDCE.
Qualifying service: IP vs PS Gr.B (Draft)	IP LDCE: 8 yrs; PS Gr.B (Draft 2024): 8 yrs from IP — both require 8 years, but from different feeder levels.
Postman LDCE quota (pre-2023 vs post-2023)	Pre-2023: 25% SCF + 25% LDCE from MTS + 50% DR (open). Post-2023: 50% LDCE from MTS + 50% (GDS Exam, then open DR).

Comparison	Key Difference
MTS recruitment (pre-2023 vs post-2023)	Pre-2023: Casual Labourers → 100% DR. Post-2023: Casual Labourers (6 steps) → GDS Quota (50%+50%) → Open DR.

18.3 The Complete Promotion Hierarchy

CLERICAL LINE: PA/SA (L-4) → LSG (L-5) → HSG-II (L-6) → HSG-I (L-7)

INSPECTOR LINE: PA/SA (L-4) → [LDCE] → IP (L-7) → ASP (L-8) → PS Gr.B (L-9) → IPoS JTS (L-10)

ACCOUNTS LINE: Group C → [SAS Exam] → AAO (L-8) → AO (L-9)

DELIVERY LINE: MTS (L-1) → [LDCE] → Postman/MG (L-3) → [LDCE to PA/SA via combined service] → joins Clerical / Inspector Line

18.4 Key Gazette Notifications – Quick Reference

Cadre	Principal Notification	Latest Operative Amendment
MTS	G.S.R. 781(E) dated 16.08.2018	G.S.R. 639(E) dated 30.08.2023
Postman & Mail Guard	G.S.R. 899(E) dated 20.09.2018	G.S.R. 638(E) dated 30.08.2023
PA / SA	G.S.R. 459(E) dated 17.06.2022	G.S.R. 470(E) dated 01.08.2024
LSG	G.S.R. 62(E) dated 31.01.2011	G.S.R. 649(E) dated 28.06.2017
HSG-II	G.S.R. 746(E) dated 19.11.2013	G.S.R. 650(E) dated 28.06.2017
HSG-I	G.S.R. 509(E) dated 17.07.2014	G.S.R. 651(E) dated 28.06.2017
Inspector Posts	G.S.R. 89(E) dated 05.02.2019	—
ASP	G.S.R. 61(E) dated 01.02.2013	G.S.R. 652(E) dated 28.06.2017
PS Gr.B	G.S.R. 379 of 1987 (re-designated 1993)	Draft RR 2024 — F.No. 9-14/2010-SPG (Vol.II) dated 11/13.11.2024 (not yet notified)
AO & AAO	G.S.R. 320(E) dated 02.04.2018	—
IPoS Group A	G.S.R. 1010(E) dated 10.08.2017	—
Staff Car Driver	G.S.R. of 2015	G.S.R. 88(E) (7th CPC update)

Cadre	Principal Notification	Latest Operative Amendment
MMS	G.S.R. 105(E) dated 18.02.2015	—

18.5 Final Mnemonic Summary

✓ **TIP:** MTS — "Six steps, then GDS twice, then open" — six casual-labourer steps, then 50%+50% GDS quota, then open DR. (Post G.S.R. 639(E)/2023.)

✓ **TIP:** Postman/MG — "Half MTS, Half GDS-or-Open" — 50% LDCE from MTS, 50% from GDS exam (failing which open market DR). (Post G.S.R. 638(E)/2023.)

✓ **TIP:** PA/SA — "40-60 with two parts" — 40% LDCE (Part A then Part B) + 60% DR. Title officially "and" not "&". (Post G.S.R. 21(E)/2023 + G.S.R. 470(E)/2024.)

✓ **TIP:** IP — "One-third DR, Two-thirds LDCE; Eight years; Forty-five years" — 33⅓% DR + 66⅔% LDCE; 8 years qualifying service; 45 years upper age for LDCE.

✓ **TIP:** PS Gr.B — "75 + 19 + 6 (operative); 100 from IP (draft)" — Current: 75/19/6 split under 1987 RR. Draft 2024: 100% from IP. Operative until Draft is gazetted.

— **End of Booklet** —

Wishing you success in your LDCE preparation.

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